



MISCELLANEOUS

Some last minute tips on other XP nitty-gritties

Removing MSN Messenger

How do you remove MSN Messenger in Windows XP? Not from the Add/Remove program list but by locating SYSOC.INF in the \Windows\INF folder (hidden file and folder). Open it in Notepad and locate the line: msmgs=msgrocm.dll,OcEntry,msmsgsgs.inf,hide,7

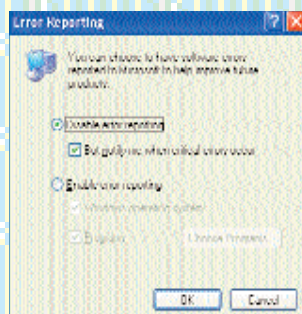


Remove the word 'hide' from the line and save the file. After making the necessary changes, you'll be able to see MSN Messenger in the Add/Remove Windows components list. You can then remove it for good.

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Disabling error reporting

Like Windows 2000, even Windows XP provides a report of errors that are generated during a session. For most home users this service might be practically useless. In order to disable it, right-click on the My



Get rid of irritating error reporting

Computer icon, go to Properties, and click on the Advanced tab. At the bottom of this tab, you will find an 'Error reporting' option. Click it and you will get an option to enable or disable it. Click Disable and you are done.

Using onscreen keyboard

An onscreen keyboard is built in Windows XP. It can be useful if you have mobility impairments, especially if you are using a tablet PC or if your keyboard goes on the blink. To access the keyboard, go to Start, click on Run, and type **osk**. Alternatively you can go to **Start > Run > Programs > Accessories > Accessibility > Onscreen keyboard**. The keyboard opens up on your computer screen, featuring three typing modes you can use to type data:

Clicking mode: you click the on-screen keys.

Scanning mode: you press a hot key or use a switch-input device to type highlighted characters.

Hovering mode: you use a mouse or joystick to point to a key, which is then typed.

Renaming multiple batch files

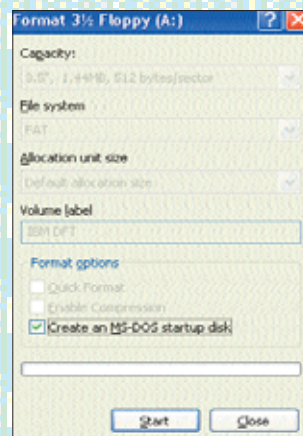
In Windows XP, you can easily rename multiple files at a single go and save a lot of time. Click Start and click My Pictures or the folder

where you have saved the pictures. Switch the view from the default Filmstrip to Thumbnails by clicking the Views button on the toolbar. Select all the pictures you want to rename by highlighting the last picture you want, then press and hold down the [Shift] key until you include all the pictures that have to be renamed, ending with the first picture in the list.

Right-click the first picture, and then click Rename. Rename the first picture, and then click in the white space next to one of the pictures. The pictures are renamed all at once!

Creating boot-up disk

In order to create a bootable floppy disk in XP, insert a floppy and go to the floppy



Create a boot-up disk

icon in My Computer. There you will have to right-click the floppy drive icon and click on the Format option. You will see the option 'Create MS-DOS Start up Disk'. After creating the boot up disk, you will be able to boot into Windows XP using this disk.



Remote Desktop Connection

Remote Desktop in Windows XP Professional gives you access to a Windows session running on your PC while you are at another computer. This means, for example, that you can connect to your office computer from home and have access to all your applications, files and network resources. You can view the desktop and programs running on your office PC on your home computer. When you connect to your computer at work, Remote Desktop automatically locks it so no one else can access your applications and files while you are gone. You can later unlock your office PC by pressing [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Del]. To access this service, go to **Start > Programs > Accessories > Communications > Remote Desktop Connection**.

